

SCHOOL CRISIS, EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT, AND MEDICAL EMERGENCY RESPONSE

The safety of all Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) students and staff are paramount. The purpose of this policy is to provide guidance on responding to a school crisis, emergency management, and medical emergency response plans.

A. Definitions

1. “School safety audit” means a written assessment of the safety conditions in each public school to (1) identify and, if necessary, develop solutions for physical safety concerns, including building security issues, and (2) identify and evaluate any patterns of student safety concerns occurring on school property or at school-sponsored events. Solutions and responses include recommendations for structural adjustments, changes in school safety procedures, and revisions to the School Board’s standards for student conduct, as set forth in the *Student Rights & Responsibilities Handbook*.

2. “School crisis, emergency management, and medical emergency response plan” means the essential procedures, operations, and assignments required to prevent, manage, and respond to a critical event or emergency, including natural disasters involving fire, flood, tornadoes, or other severe weather, loss or disruption of power, water, communications, or shelter, bus or other accidents, medical emergencies, including cardiac arrest and other life-threatening medical emergencies, student or staff member deaths, explosions, bomb threats, gun, knife or other weapons threats, spills or exposures to hazardous substances, the presence of unauthorized persons or trespassers, the loss, disappearance, or kidnapping of a student, hostage situations, violence on school property or at school activities, incidents involving acts of terrorism, and other incidents posing a serious threat of harm to students, personnel, or facilities.

B. School Safety and Emergency Management

1. The School Board designates the Director of Safety and Security as its emergency manager.

2. In the Commonwealth of Virginia, all public schools are required to conduct an annual school safety audit in order to assess school safety conditions. Through enabling legislation (Va. Code § 9.1-184), the Virginia Center for School and Campus Safety (VCSCS) has been designated to collect, analyze, and disseminate various Virginia school safety data, including school safety audit information.

3. The school crisis, emergency management, and medical emergency response plan shall include a provision that the Virginia Department of Criminal Justice Services and the Virginia Criminal Injuries Compensation Fund shall be contacted immediately to deploy assistance in the event of an emergency, as defined in the emergency response plan, when there are victims, as defined in Va. Code § 19.2-11.01, as well as current contact information for both.

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4. The Superintendent or designee will develop regulations for the implementation of the requirements of this policy.

Adopted: 6/27/23

Legal Refs: Code of Virginia §§ [2.2-3705.2](#), [19.2-11.01](#), [9.1-184](#), [22.1-279.8](#); Acts 2006, c. 164; [8 VAC 20-131-260](#)